



Allow UTF8MB4

Install guide. Permanently enables utf8mb4 encoding across core database tables so emojis and 4-byte Unicode characters survive save, instead of being silently stripped.

PACKAGE	MODULE	REQUIRES	LICENSE
blueprint3d/module-allow-utf8mb4	BluePrint3D_AllowUtf8mb4	Magento 2.4.x MySQL 8.4+ (or modern MariaDB)	Proprietary EULA

1 What it does

By default, older Magento 2 installs configure MySQL tables with the legacy 3-byte utf8 (utf8mb3) character set. A 4-byte character - an emoji, or a rarer Unicode symbol - gets silently truncated or replaced with question marks on save.

This module ships a targeted data patch that runs during deployment. It converts the key tables - Products, CMS Pages, CMS Blocks, and Customer data - to utf8mb4 and sets the active collation to utf8mb4_unicode_ci, without truncating or destroying any existing content.

NO ADMIN UI There is nothing to configure. Once installed and upgraded, the module works silently in the background.

2 Installation

1 Install via Composer

```
$ composer require blueprint3d/module-allow-utf8mb4
```

2 Enable the module

```
$ php bin/magento module:enable BluePrint3D_AllowUtf8mb4
```

3 Run setup upgrade

```
$ php bin/magento setup:upgrade
```

4 Compile and flush cache

```
$ php bin/magento setup:di:compile
$ php bin/magento cache:flush
```

Step 3 (setup:upgrade) is what applies the utf8mb4 data patch - do not skip it.

3 Before you install: check your MySQL version

READ FIRST Magento's declarative schema has no column-level charset/collation attribute, only a table-level one. On MySQL below 8.0.29, every setup:upgrade silently regenerates these columns back to Magento's legacy default charset - undoing the conversion, regardless of what this module declares. This is not fixable from db_schema.xml alone.

On MySQL 8.4+ (or a modern MariaDB), Magento's own framework defaults these columns to utf8mb4 natively on every setup:upgrade, so this module's one-shot patch is all you need - it stays fixed with no further action.

If you are still on an older MySQL version, upgrade the database first. Do not rely on this module alone to keep emoji support working across future deploys.

4 Using it

Go to **Content > Blocks** or **Catalog > Products** and paste emojis or extended Unicode characters directly into any text field. They will save and display correctly across storefront and admin.